

Aijia Zhang

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Research Interests

Empirical Corporate Finance, Corporate Governance, Foreign Institutional Investors, and Chinese Capital Markets.

Education

University of Glasgow <i>PhD in Finance Programme</i> Expected Graduation: December 2026	10/2022–Present <i>Glasgow, UK</i>
University of Glasgow <i>Master of Science in Management with International Finance with Distinction</i>	01/2021–03/2022 <i>Glasgow, UK</i>
Beijing Normal - Hong Kong Baptist University United International College (UIC) <i>Bachelor of Business Administration (Honours) in Applied Economics</i>	09/2016–06/2020 <i>Zhuhai, China</i>

Working Papers (selected presentations by co-author denoted by *)

- **Foreign Institutional Investors' Site Visits and Tunnelling** (*Job Market Paper*)
This study investigates how foreign institutional investors' (FIIs) site visits affect tunnelling through inter-corporate loans. Using all Chinese firms listed on the Shenzhen Stock Exchange from 2012 to 2022, I find that FIIs' site visits significantly curb tunnelling across three different measures of site visits. Propensity score matching and multi-period difference-in-difference analysis show that this relation is causal. The effect is more pronounced when FIIs hold larger stakes, indicating that greater ownership enhances the effectiveness of their more frequent and intensive site visits in curbing tunnelling. The curbing effect of FIIs' site visits on tunnelling is more significant than that of site visits by other institutional investors, including Hong Kong, Macao, and Taiwan (HMT), Sino-foreign, and mainland institutional investors. Finally, we show that FIIs play a more effective monitoring role if they visit in groups rather than alone. The study contributes to the literature on tunnelling problems and the disciplining role of FIIs in weak institutional environments.
- Selected presentations: FMA (2025), FMA Europe (2025), EFMA (2025), CEA (2025)
- **Foreign Institutional Investors and Underperforming CEOs: Evidence from Chinese Listed Firms** (*with Martin Strieborny*)
Using a sample of Chinese listed firms from 2009 to 2023, we show that foreign institutional shareholdings raise CEO turnover-performance sensitivity, and we identify two transmission channels driving this result: the quality of corporate governance and stock price informativeness. We address endogeneity concerns with a staggered difference-in-differences analysis exploiting the exogenous shock to foreign institutional ownership from the introduction of the Shanghai/Shenzhen–Hong Kong Stock Connect Program.
- Selected presentations: AsianFA (2026), EFMA (2026), Humboldt University* (2025)
- **Investor-Firm Interactions and Corporate Innovation: Evidence from China**
Using 6,115 Chinese A-share listed firms over 2010–2023, this paper shows that investor-firm interactions on regulated online platforms are positively associated with subsequent innovation, measured by granted invention patents, with financial constraints acting as a partial mediating channel. The effect is stronger when information asymmetry is higher and institutional monitoring is weaker, suggesting that such platforms promote innovation by reducing information asymmetry between retail investors and firm management.

Conference Presentations

2026:

Financial Management Association (FMA) Annual Meeting (Tampa)
Asian Finance Association (AsianFA) Annual Meeting (Seoul)
European Financial Management Association (EFMA) Annual Meeting (Kristiansand)

2025:

Financial Management Association (FMA) Annual Meeting (Vancouver)
Financial Management Association (FMA) European Conference (Limassol)
European Financial Management Association (EFMA) Annual Meeting (Athens)
Chinese Economic Association (CEA) Annual Conference (Glasgow)

Discussions

2026: AsianFA (Seoul), EFMA (Kristiansand)

2025: FMA (Vancouver), FMA Europe (Limassol), EFMA (Athens)

Academic Services

University of Glasgow

01/2025–Present

Co-organisier, Internal Seminars for Finance PhDs

Glasgow, UK

- Organising a seminar series in which finance PhD students present their research and receive feedback, and inviting faculty members to discuss their own papers or share job market insights.

University of Glasgow

10/2023–Present

Graduate Teaching Assistant (GTA)

- Course: Foundations of International Corporate Finance (postgraduate course).
Explaining key concepts in international corporate finance, including agency conflicts, mergers and acquisitions, and the time value of money. Providing guidance on effectively reading and interpreting corporate finance literature.

Awards, Grants, and Certificates

Employability Funding, Adam Smith Business School with multiple awards (PhD) 2025

CFA Level I Pass 2020

Academic Excellence Scholarship, First Class (Undergraduate) 2019/2020

Academic Excellence Scholarship, Second Class (Undergraduate) 2018/2019

Skills

Software: Python, Matlab, Stata, EViews, SPSS, LaTeX and Microsoft-based software

Databases: CSMAR (China Stock Market & Accounting Research), CNRDS (Chinese Research Data Services), Wind, Qichacha, Bloomberg, BoardEx

Languages: Chinese (Native), English (Fluent), Korean (Intermediate)

References

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